

## **Social Contract Theory**

**Thomas Hobbes:** Believed that in a "State of Nature," life is "solitary, poor, nasty, brutish, and short." People give up all rights to a single absolute sovereign (The Leviathan) in exchange for safety.

**Jean-Jacques Rousseau:** Argued that "Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains." He believed in the "General Will"—that the laws of a state should reflect the collective interest of the citizens, not just a king.

**Key Concept:** The social contract is an implicit agreement among the members of a society to cooperate for social benefits, usually by sacrificing some individual freedom for state protection.